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Nexora ERP

Complete User Guide

System workflow, every module, worked examples

v1 — 2026

Nexora ERP — Complete User Guide

A system workflow guide covering every module, from setting up a shop to running day-to-day operations, with worked examples. Written for shop owners, cashiers, accountants, and anyone operating the system — not for developers (see `README.md` for that).

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1. What this system is

Nexora ERP is a multi-tenant ERP/POS platform for local shops and wholesalers — one system covering inventory, purchasing, sales, accounting, payroll, light manufacturing, and e-commerce sync,

built so that a sale at the counter flows automatically through to your trial balance without anyone re-typing anything.

Three ideas run through every module and are worth knowing before you start:

- **Nothing is ever edited or deleted, only reversed.** A wrong invoice isn't fixed by changing it — you post a return or a correcting entry, and both the mistake and the fix stay on the record. This is what makes every report trustworthy.
- **Stock and money move together.** Receiving goods, selling goods, and making/receiving payments automatically post the correct accounting entries behind the scenes. You almost never need to touch the Journal directly.
- **Every shop (tenant) is isolated.** If you run multiple shops/companies, each is a separate workspace with its own data, users, and books.

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2. Getting started

2.1 Creating your shop (sign-up)

Go to `/signup`. You'll fill in two sections:

1. **Your shop** — shop name, a *slug* (lowercase, used to sign in — e.g. `my-hardware-shop`), and your business type (hardware, pharmacy, grocery, textile, wholesale, or general). The business type picks a starter chart of accounts with a few extra accounts relevant to that trade (e.g. pharmacies get an "Expired/Damaged Stock Write-off" account).
2. **Your account** — your name, email, and a password (minimum 8 characters).

Example: Signing up a new hardware shop called "Perera Hardware" with slug `perera-hardware` automatically creates:

- A Head Office branch
- A full chart of accounts (Cash, Bank, Receivables, Payables, Inventory, Sales Revenue, COGS, Expenses, etc.)
- Four system roles (Owner, Accountant, Branch Manager, Cashier)
- You, as Owner, on the free POS plan (upgradeable later)

2.2 Signing in

Go to `/login`. Unlike most systems, sign-in needs **three** things, not two:

Field	Example
Shop	`demo-hardware`

Field	Example
Email	`owner@demo.shop`
Password	`ChangeMe123!`

The shop slug is what tells the system which company's books you're signing into — the same email could exist in two different shops.

2.3 Roles, in one line each

- **Owner** — everything.
- **Accountant** — posts journals, closes periods, runs payroll, imports opening balances, views all financial reports.
- **Branch Manager** — runs day-to-day operations for one branch: stock, purchasing, sales, HR, manufacturing, e-commerce — but can't post manual journal entries or close accounting periods.
- **Cashier** — sells at the POS, nothing else (can't see cost prices or post anything financial).

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3. Initial setup — before you sell anything

Do these in order the first time:

1. **Chart of accounts** is already there (auto-created at sign-up) — check it at `Chart of Accounts` if you want to add your own expense categories.
2. **Warehouses** (`Inventory → Warehouses`) — at least one, tied to a branch. *Example: "Main Store — Colombo", code* `MAIN` .
3. **Products** (`Master data → Products`) — SKU, name, base unit of measure (e.g. "Piece"), cost price, selling price. You can add unit conversions too (e.g. 1 box = 24 pieces).
4. **Customers / Suppliers** (`Master data → Customers` / `Suppliers`) — name, phone, credit limit, credit term days (e.g. 30 days).
5. **Opening balances**, if you're migrating from an old system — see 5.11 Pilot support tools.
6. **Invoice branding** (`Settings → Invoice Branding`) — your logo, accent color, address/phone/email, and a footer note, so printed invoices look like your shop's, not a generic template.

Bulk setup tip: Products, customers, and suppliers all support Excel import — if you're migrating from a spreadsheet, use the import option on each page instead of typing everything in one at a time.

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4. A day in the life — end-to-end walkthrough

This section follows one example transaction all the way through the system, so you can see how the modules connect.

Scenario: Perera Hardware buys 50 hammers from a supplier, then sells 2 of them to a walk-in customer at the counter.

Step 1 — Order stock from a supplier

`Purchasing → Purchase Orders` → new PO to "ABC Tools Ltd" for 50 hammers at Rs. 800 each.

Step 2 — Receive the goods (GRN)

When the hammers physically arrive: `Purchasing → GRN` → post a Goods Received Note against that PO. This is the moment stock actually increases — the stock ledger gets a real, permanent movement, and the system posts:

```
Dr  Inventory (GRN value)       40,000
    Cr  GRN Clearing                    40,000
```

Step 3 — Record the supplier's invoice

`Purchasing → Supplier Invoices` → match it to the GRN. This clears the GRN Clearing account and creates a real payable:

```
Dr  GRN Clearing              40,000
    Cr  Accounts Payable              40,000
```

Step 4 — Pay the supplier

`Purchasing → Supplier Payments` → pay Rs. 40,000 by bank transfer, allocated against that invoice. `Payables Aging` now shows nothing outstanding for ABC Tools.

Step 5 — Sell at the counter

A customer walks in wanting 2 hammers. At the register:

1. If the till isn't open yet, `POS` first asks you to **open the register** — count your starting cash float (e.g. Rs. 5,000) and confirm.
2. Click the "Hammer" product card twice (or once, then bump the quantity to 2) — it's added to the cart at Rs. 1,200 each.

3. Pick **Cash** as the payment method, click **Complete sale**.

This single click does four things at once, atomically:

- Raises a sales invoice (Rs. 2,400)
- Posts a delivery, reducing stock by 2 units
- Records a payment, marking the invoice paid
- Posts the accounting entries:

```
Dr  Cash in Hand              2,400
    Cr  Sales Revenue                   2,400
Dr  Cost of Goods Sold          1,600   (2 × weighted-avg cost)
    Cr  Inventory                       1,600
```

Step 6 — End of day

Still on the POS screen: **Close register**. Enter what you actually counted in the drawer. The system already knows the expected amount (opening float + every cash sale since you opened), so it tells you the variance immediately — Rs. 0 means the till balanced.

Step 7 — Check the numbers

`Reports` or `Accounting → Reports` shows today's sales, margin on the hammer sale, and the P&L already reflecting both the purchase and the sale — no manual bookkeeping needed anywhere in this flow.

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5. Module reference

5.1 Master data

Screen	What it's for
Products	SKUs, variants, units of measure, cost/selling price, barcodes
Customers	Credit limit, credit term days, contact details
Suppliers	Same, for the other side of the ledger
Chart of Accounts	Your tenant's accounts — add custom expense categories here

Example: Adding a product with unit conversion — "Nails" sold by the Kg but bought from the supplier by the 25kg bag: set base UoM = `KG`, then add a conversion `BAG = 25 KG`. Purchasing can then order in bags while stock and sales stay in kilograms.

5.2 Inventory

Screen	What it's for
Warehouses	Physical/logical stock locations, tied to a branch
Stock	Current on-hand quantity and value, by warehouse
Transfers	Move stock between two warehouses
Adjustments	Correct stock for damage, loss, or found items — always with a reason, never a silent edit
Stock Counts	Physical count reconciliation — enter what you counted, the system posts the adjusting movement automatically

Every single change to stock — a sale, a purchase, a transfer, an adjustment, a production order — writes a permanent row to the stock ledger. "Stock on hand" is never a number you edit; it's always the sum of these rows.

5.3 Purchasing

Flow: Purchase Order → GRN → Supplier Invoice → Supplier Payment (with Purchase Returns and Payables Aging alongside).

Screen	What it's for
Purchase Orders	What you've ordered from a supplier
GRN	What's actually arrived (can differ from the PO)
Supplier Invoices	The supplier's bill, matched to the GRN
Supplier Payments	Paying what you owe, allocated to specific invoices
Purchase Returns	Sending goods back to a supplier
Payables Aging	Who you owe, and how overdue

5.4 Sales

Flow: Quotation → Sales Order → Sales Invoice → Delivery → Receipt (with Sales Returns and Receivables Aging alongside).

Screen	What it's for
Quotations	A price quote for a customer, not yet a commitment
Sales Orders	A confirmed order, not yet invoiced
Sales Invoices	The bill — click **View / Print** on any invoice to get a branded, printable PDF-ready page

Screen	What it's for
Deliveries	Shipping/handing over goods (moves stock)
Receipts	Payments received from customers
Sales Returns	Customer sends something back (credit note)
Receivables Aging	Who owes you, and how overdue

Example — credit sale: A regular customer with 30-day credit terms buys Rs. 50,000 of goods. You raise a Sales Invoice (due date auto-calculated: today + 30 days), post a Delivery to move the stock out, and the invoice sits as "unpaid" on Receivables Aging until a Receipt is recorded against it.

5.5 Point of sale (POS)

The fast path for walk-in, pay-now sales — see the day-in-the-life example above for the full flow. Key things to know:

- **You must open the cash register** before the POS will let you sell anything — this is deliberate, so every shift's cash is accounted for.
- Clicking a product card adds one unit to the cart; click again (or use the +/− stepper in the cart) to adjust quantity.
- Payment methods: Cash, Bank, Cheque. Only **cash** sales count toward the register's expected closing balance.
- **Closing the register** shows you the variance (counted − expected) immediately — use this to catch missing or duplicate sales before they pile up.

5.6 Accounting

Screen	What it's for
Expenses	Simple day-to-day spending entry (rent, utilities, supplies) — pick a category, amount, and who it was paid from; no debit/credit knowledge needed
Journal	Manual double-entry postings, for anything the other modules don't auto-post — restricted to Accountant/Owner
Periods	Lock a month once it's finalized so nothing can be posted into it by accident
Cheques	Post-dated cheque tracking (received and issued)
Bank Reconciliation	Match your bank statement against what the system recorded
Reports	Trial Balance, Profit & Loss, Balance Sheet

Example — recording an expense: `Accounting → Expenses` → date, branch, category "Utilities Expense", amount Rs. 4,500, paid from "Cash in hand", description "Electricity bill for October". This posts `Dr Utilities Expense / Cr Cash in Hand` for you — no journal entry needed.

5.7 Reports & dashboard

The **Dashboard** gives an at-a-glance view: today's sales, customer/supplier counts, this month's net profit, a 14-day sales chart, a 6-month revenue-vs-expenses chart, and top products by revenue — plus quick links into the screens you use most.

`Reports` adds: sales by day, top products, top customers, margin by product, dead stock (items not selling), and stock valuation.

5.8 HR & payroll

Screen	What it's for
Employees	Staff records — basic salary, fixed allowances, EPF/ETF member numbers, bank details. Separate from system *users*, since most paid staff never log in.
Payroll	Run a month's payroll, then mark it paid

Example — running November payroll: `HR → Payroll` → select branch, year 2026, month 11 → **Run payroll**. For every active employee, the system computes:

- EPF: 8% employee + 12% employer, on basic salary only
- ETF: 3% employer, on basic salary only
- APIT (income tax): from a built-in bracket table, computed on (gross − employee EPF)
- Net pay: gross − employee EPF − APIT

This posts a journal entry splitting gross salary expense, employer EPF/ETF cost, and the resulting EPF/ETF/APIT/net-pay liabilities. Once reviewed, click **Mark paid** to record the actual bank/cash disbursement — a separate step from "run," so you can review before money moves.

5.9 Manufacturing

For shops that assemble or process goods rather than just reselling them.

1. **Bills of Materials** (`Manufacturing → Bills of Materials`) — define a recipe: one output product + a list of component products and quantities needed per batch.
2. **Production Orders** (`Manufacturing → Production Orders`) — create an order against a BOM for N batches, then **Complete** it once production is actually done, entering the actual output quantity (which can differ from planned, e.g. if some was spoiled).

Example: A hardware shop assembles "Tool Kit Combo" from 1× hammer + 1× screwdriver set + 1× tape measure. The BOM defines that recipe; a production order for 10 kits consumes 10 of each component and produces 10 kits, each costed at the actual total component cost ÷ actual output — no separate accounting entry needed, since the value just moves from components to finished goods.

5.10 E-commerce sync

For shops with an online storefront (their own site, or a platform like WooCommerce/Shopify).

1. `E-commerce → Sales Channels` → create a channel (e.g. "Main Website"). This generates an **API key** (for the storefront to read your product feed) and a **webhook secret** (to sign incoming orders).
2. **Link products**: map your internal SKU to however the storefront identifies that product.
3. The storefront polls `/api/ecommerce/feed/{apiKey}` for live price/stock, and POSTs new orders to `/api/ecommerce/webhook/{apiKey}` (signed with the webhook secret) — each valid order automatically becomes a real sales order in the system.

5.11 Pilot support tools

Built for the "run in parallel with the old system for a month" migration period — see `PILOT.md` for the full process checklist.

Screen	What it's for
Opening Balances	One-time go-live import: opening stock, opening customer balances (receivables), opening supplier balances (payables) — posted as real, correct ledger entries against an "Opening Balance Equity" account, not a backdoor edit
Weekly Reconciliation	Enter the shop's manually-counted figure for sales/cash/stock value; the system figure is always computed live, so the comparison never goes stale
Issues	An in-app bug/confusion tracker — any role can report, managers triage

5.12 Accountant portal

A **separate login** (`/accountant/login`) for an external accountant who works across multiple shops. A shop owner invites an accountant by email from `Settings → Linked Accountants`; the accountant then signs in once and switches between every company that's invited them, seeing a live trial balance and journal list for each (currently view-only).

5.13 Platform admin

A **separate login** (`/admin/login`) for whoever operates the platform itself (not a shop owner). Lists every tenant with usage (branches/users/products), lets you change a tenant's plan tier, and shows a

cross-tenant view of every pilot issue reported, from any shop.

5.14 Settings

Screen	What it's for
Settings	Tenant name, business details
Invoice Branding	Logo, accent color, letterhead address/phone/email, footer note — applied to every printed sales invoice
Linked Accountants	Invite/remove external accountant access
Users	Add staff logins and assign them a role

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6. Roles and who can do what

Can they...	Owner	Accountant	Branch Manager	Cashier
Sell at POS	✅	—	✅	✅
Manage products/customers/suppliers	✅	—	✅	—
Purchasing (PO/GRN/invoices)	✅	partial	✅	—
Post manual journal entries	✅	✅	—	—
Close accounting periods	✅	✅	—	—
Record a simple expense	✅	✅	✅	—
Run payroll	✅	✅	—	—
Manage employees	✅	—	✅	—
Manufacturing (BOM/production)	✅	—	✅	—
E-commerce channels	✅	—	✅	—
Import opening balances (go-live)	✅	✅	—	—
Report a pilot issue	✅	✅	✅	✅
Manage users & settings	✅	—	—	—

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7. Appendix

Demo credentials (seeded data, for trying the system)

System	Login	Credentials
Tenant app	`/login`	shop `demo-hardware`, `owner@demo.shop` / `ChangeMe123!`
Platform admin	`/admin/login`	`admin@platform.local` / `AdminPass123!` *(change before any real deployment)*

Plan tiers

Tier	Includes
POS	Sales, POS — 1 branch, 3 users, 200 products
Business	+ Inventory, Purchasing — 5 branches, 15 users, 2,000 products
ERP	+ Accounting, Payroll, Manufacturing, E-commerce, Accountant portal — unlimited

Known limitations, honestly stated

- Purchase/sales returns don't automatically net against the aging reports — a return is its own document.
- Payment overpayments beyond the total outstanding aren't tracked as a credit balance.
- The accountant portal is currently **view-only** — an accountant can see a company's books but not post journal entries into them yet.
- The super-admin "view tenant" action is an audit-logged event, not true session impersonation.
- The daily SMS summary needs real Notify.lk credentials configured before it will actually send.

This guide covers the system as built. For architectural/technical documentation, see `README.md`; for the real-world pilot process, see `PILOT.md`.